

FADE IN:

EXT. DESERT HIGHWAY - DAWN

Two sisters push a dead station wagon onto the shoulder. LENA (34, sleeves rolled, jaw set) steers through the window. JUNE (26, sunburn, headphones around her neck) pushes from the back.

The wagon rolls to a stop. Dust settles. Nothing in any direction but salt and sky.

JUNE
That's it. That's the whole plan.

LENA
The plan was Reno.

JUNE
The plan was Reno by Tuesday.

Lena looks at the horizon like it owes her money.

INT. STATION WAGON - DAWN

June digs through the glovebox for a flashlight and finds an envelope instead. Cream paper. Their mother's handwriting.

She turns it over. Doesn't open it.

JUNE
Lena.

LENA (O.S.)
Not now.

June puts it back exactly where it was. Lena pretends not to notice.

EXT. GAS STATION - DAY

A two-pump station with a diner bolted to the side. The wagon sits on a flatbed. THE MECHANIC (60s, cap, hands like roots) wipes them on a rag that makes them dirtier.

THE MECHANIC
Transmission.

LENA
How much.

THE MECHANIC
More than the car.

JUNE
How much more than the car?

THE MECHANIC
Depends how much you love the car.

He quotes a price. Neither of them has it. Lena doesn't blink; June does, three times.

INT. GAS STATION DINER - DAY

Pie, coffee, and the first real fight. A WAITRESS (50s, name tag reads DOT) refills their cups without being asked.

WAITRESS
(refilling)
Y'all the wagon?

JUNE
We're the wagon.

WAITRESS
Walt at the motel trades. Cars, mostly. Sometimes work.

She leaves the check. Lena slides it to June. June slides it back.

LENA
You said you had money.

JUNE
I said I had a plan.

LENA
You said the plan was money.

JUNE
The plan was Reno.

They eat the pie anyway. It's good pie.

EXT. GAS STATION - DUSK

June sits on the curb with the envelope. A KID (10, bike, a sack of maps) coasts up.

KID
Map's a dollar.

JUNE
Of what?

KID

Everything.

She buys it. He rides off. The map is of the county, and it is mostly white.

INT. MOTEL ROOM - NIGHT

Two beds, one lamp, a window unit that sounds like a truck idling. Lena lies on top of the covers, boots on.

June sits on the other bed. The envelope is in her hands. Opened.

LENA
Read it, then.

JUNE
You read it.

LENA
I don't want to read it. I want it read.

June reads. We don't hear it. We watch Lena's face, which does not change, and then does.

EXT. MOTEL POOL - NIGHT

The pool is empty. Not drained; never filled. Lena lies on her back on the bottom of the deep end and looks straight up.

Stars. A lot of them. Too many to be fair.

INT. MOTEL OFFICE - MORNING

A bell on the door. WALT (70, suspenders, reading glasses on a cord) looks up from a crossword he is not doing.

WALT
The wagon.

JUNE
Everybody knows about the wagon.

WALT
Small county. Big wagon.

He takes off the glasses.

WALT (CONT'D)
I've got a Datsun runs fine. Yours for a week of work. Sheets, pool,

the ice machine when it feels like
it.

JUNE
The pool's empty.

WALT
That's the work.

EXT. MOTEL PARKING LOT - MORNING

Lena says no. June says yes. They say it at the same time,
to Walt, who has heard this before.

WALT
I'll let you two settle it.

He goes inside. The sisters stand in the lot with the
Datsun between them like a chaperone.

LENA
We're not staying.

JUNE
We're not leaving. Those are the
two things we're not doing, so.

Lena kicks the Datsun's tire. It holds.

FADE OUT.